

# Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Link, Local Payment Methods.*

*Positioning*, payments infrastructure builder with 13 years of delivery across fintech, regulated SaaS, and consumer-facing products, now focused on scaling global payment networks.

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Dear Stripe Link Team,

Payments infrastructure is only as good as what the end user never notices. I built Kvitt, a mobile P2P payments product, from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, which means I learned early that consumer trust in a payment experience is lost in the edge cases: the declined method, the confusing fallback, the moment the UI asks the user to make a decision that the product should have made for them. The Link team's mission to give consumers the freedom to pay with their preferred methods across millions of merchants, without exposing that complexity to either side, is the right framing for this problem.

My path since Kvitt has run through every layer of the regulated product stack. At EMIL Group I shipped a Claims Center from concept to production in an 18-person organisation that was losing both its engineers and its client trust; I restructured it into three lean teams and cut attrition from near-total to a single departure. At Rohde & Schwarz I redirected the data platform strategy for a multinational defence programme based on instrumented workflow analysis, the "beautiful" UI-led workflow recorded exactly zero clicks, so we pivoted to developer-code-first and pipeline runs increased 200%. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration simultaneously while containerising a bare-metal system and cutting data-update time by 75%. These are not payments stories, but they are the same story: rigorous discovery, instrument before you build, protect the user from complexity.

The local payment methods space adds a dimension I find genuinely interesting: the strategy is not just about UX or engineering, it is about market-by-market scheme relationships, consumer trust patterns, and the economics of method mix for the merchant. The experience I bring from Scheidt & Bachmann's POS and forecourt payment systems, moving research through a SAFe organisation into production, and from the AOK procurement webshop migration maps directly onto the coordination work that comes with expanding a network like Link into new markets and new method categories. I am comfortable sitting at the boundary between merchant-facing product decisions and consumer-facing experience design, because both sides of that equation need to be right for conversion to move.

I work with data as a first-order product input, not as a reporting afterthought. I write the SQL I need, define the KPIs before the sprint starts, and check them after it ends. At construct8 I built funnel and conversion analysis in SQL from the start, as a solo founder, because I was not willing to make roadmap decisions without measurement. At the Bundesagentur I instrumented the pipeline before proposing the strategy shift. At Rohde & Schwarz the workflow analysis preceded the pivot. The pattern is consistent: I want to know what is actually happening before I decide what to build next.

Stripe's platform is the infrastructure layer that a large fraction of global commerce runs on. Working on Link's local payment methods means operating at the intersection of that infrastructure and the consumer moments where trust is either earned or lost. I would bring ownership, data discipline, and the ability to hold the merchant and consumer perspectives simultaneously, and I would be glad to talk through what that looks like in practice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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